Payments API Integration Guide

Payments platform · API version 2 · Updated 10 September 2026

> Fictional sample document for testing a domain-specialist RAG.

1. Authentication

Call the API at `https://api.payments.example/v2`. Authenticate every request with the header `Authorization: Bearer <access_token>`. Access tokens are issued by the OAuth 2.0 client-credentials flow and expire after 15 minutes. Never embed the client secret in mobile or browser code.

2. Creating a payment

`POST /v2/payments` creates a payment. Amounts are integers in the smallest currency unit (paise for INR), so ₹499.00 is sent as `49900`. Supported currencies are INR, USD and EUR.

Every POST must include an `Idempotency-Key` header with a UUID v4. Keys are remembered for 24 hours; repeating a request with the same key returns the original result instead of charging twice.

```
POST /v2/payments
Idempotency-Key: 5f1c2c1e-8a8e-4c9d-9a57-2f1f6f3f2a10
{"amount": 49900, "currency": "INR", "customer_id": "cus_42", "capture": true}
```

3. Rate limits and errors

Limit or code	Meaning
100 requests per minute	Per API key. Exceeding it returns HTTP 429 with a Retry-After header in seconds.
409 Conflict	Same Idempotency-Key reused with a different body.
422 Unprocessable	Validation error; the body lists the invalid fields.
503 Unavailable	Retry with exponential backoff, at most 3 attempts.

4. Webhooks

Payment events are delivered to your HTTPS endpoint. Each webhook carries an `X-Signature` header: the HMAC-SHA256 of the raw request body using your webhook secret, hex encoded, and an `X-Timestamp` header. Reject any webhook whose signature does not match, or whose timestamp is more than 5 minutes old, to prevent replay. Compare signatures with a constant-time function such as `hmac.compare_digest`.

Respond with HTTP 200 within 10 seconds. Undelivered webhooks are retried for up to 72 hours.

5. Refunds

`POST /v2/refunds` refunds all or part of a captured payment. Refunds are allowed up to 180 days after capture. Partial refunds may be issued until the total refunded equals the captured amount.